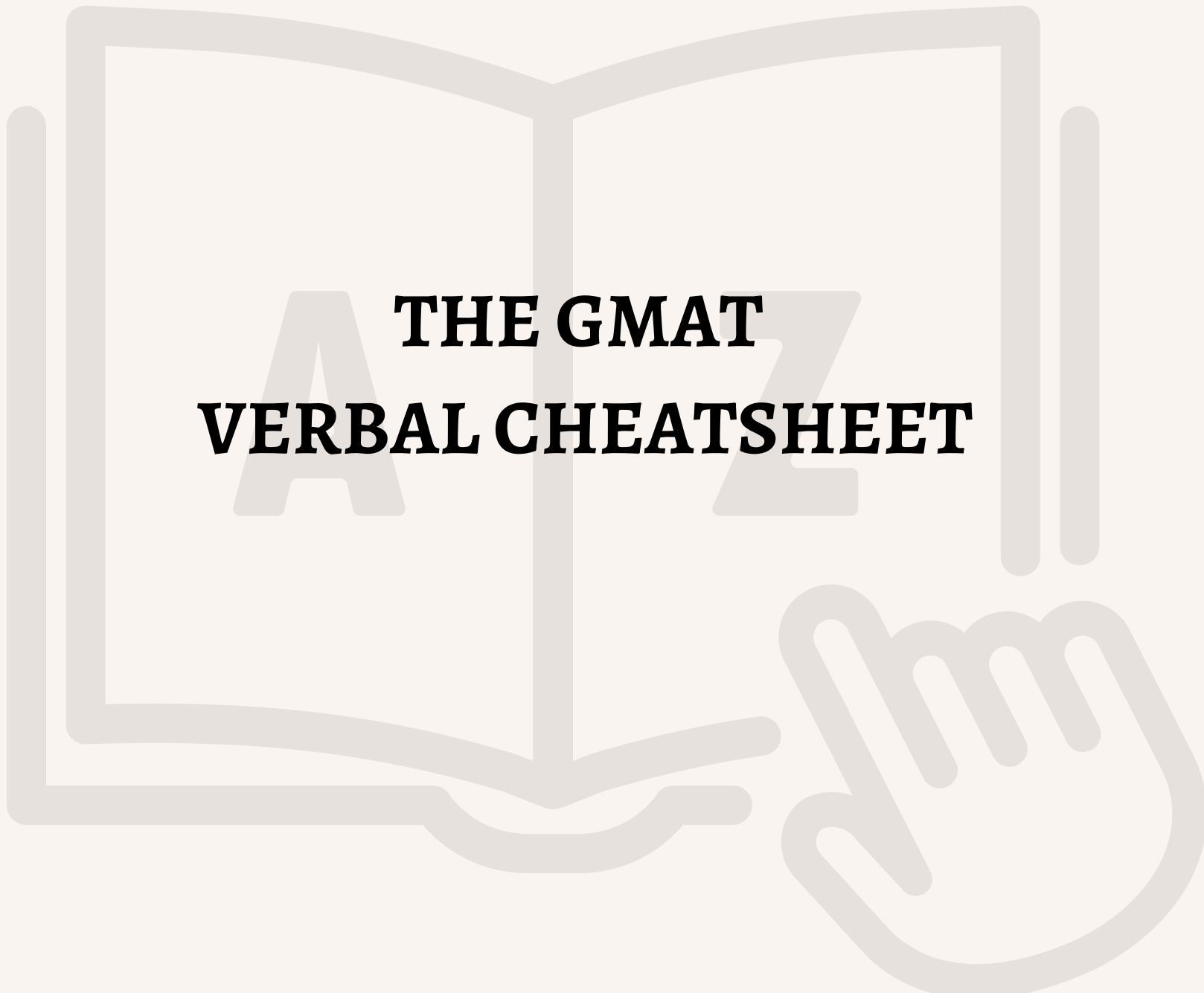




THE GMAT VERBAL CHEATSHEET

CHAPTER 1: READING COMPREHENSION

Chapter Flow

1

Things to keep in mind while answering RC Questions

2

Using the STOP method and TOP TIPS

3

How to answer the 6 question types in RC



THINGS TO KEEP IN MIND WHILE ANSWERING RC QUESTIONS

Pay attention to the overall structure and purpose

Understand the structure of the author's argument, including the reason for each paragraph and how they relate to one another. This will help you prepare for the contextual questions that will appear on the exam.

1

Be fully awake and focused

Engage fully with the passage even if it talks about something that does not sound as interesting to you. Note-taking on the overall argument might facilitate this process.

3

Improve your reading skills and abilities

If you're not seeing improvement in your reading comprehension scores even after following the above strategies, it may be because your English reading skills are weak. To improve, focus on reading challenging materials daily, whether fiction or non-fiction.

5

2

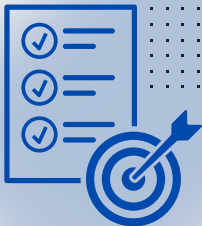
Don't try to memorize all the given details

It's important to remember that all the facts will be on the screen when needed, so there is no need to memorize them or focus on every detail. Instead, the focus should be on understanding the purpose behind each paragraph and how it connects to the author's overall argument.

4

Eliminate the wrong answers

Don't just look for one correct answer, but rather eliminate four incorrect ones. It is important to make sure that you eliminate four wrong answers instead of just finding one right answer.





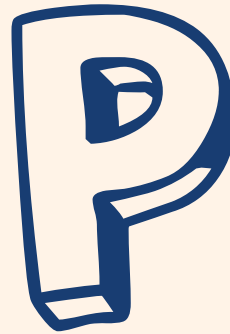
Summarize your initial reading and understanding of the passage using the **"STOP"** method.



SCOPE: From your initial reading you should understand how the boundaries of the passage relate to the primary purpose.



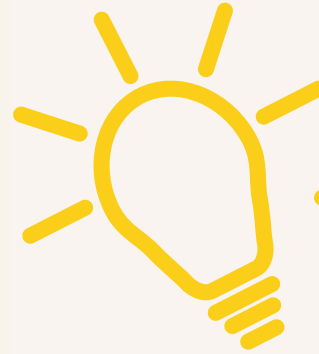
tone: Understand the tone of the author e.g critical, optimistic, reverent etc.



organization: Broadly understand the topic of each paragraph and recognize any important transitions in the passage



Purpose: Try to grasp the primary purpose of the passage. Primary purpose relates directly to both scope and tone.



TOP TIPS

Do not try to be an expert.

Answer the questions relying solely on the information in the passage. There's no need to master a given subject to answer the questions.

Be problem-driven and not passage driven.

The harder questions are more about reasoning than they are about knowledge. Look out for the presence of cause/effect relationship and drivers of logic



Leverage information.

Easy-moderate problems can often be answered with just verbatim information; difficult problems often require you to use the given statement to prove the statement that answers the question.

HOW TO ANSWER THE 6 QUESTION TYPES IN RC



01. FINDING THE MAIN IDEA

- Identify the crux of the author's point
- identify the thesis of the passage and those ideas that support this thesis.



The correct answer to a main point question is often a paraphrase of the conclusion or thesis statement of the passage.



Incorrect answer choices are those that feature supporting ideas

02. FINDING THE SUPPORTING IDEA

- Identify which ideas in the passage play a supporting role and which idea is being supported.



It is extremely important that you stick quite close to the text to find the correct answer.



Answers that seem logical but are not directly supported by the text should be avoided.

03. INFERENCE BASED

- Make a very small logical conclusion that is strongly implied based upon information in the passage.



The correct answer is usually an obvious logical consequence of a sentence in the text.



Stay away from answer choices that do not directly and closely follow from a statement in the passage.

COMMON QUESTION STEMS

- Which of the following most accurately states the main idea of the passage?
- The primary purpose of the passage is to
- The author of this passage is primarily concerned with

- According to the passage, a questionable assumption about x is that
- Which of the following is true of x
- The passage mentions each of the following EXCEPT
- According to the passage, if x occurs then

- The passage implies that which of the following was true of x
- It can be inferred from the passage that
- The author implies that x occurred because

HOW TO ANSWER THE 6 QUESTION TYPES IN RC



04. TONE & STYLE

- Identify the attitude or mood of a specific part of the passage or of the entire passage.



Recognize the disposition of the author, which is signalled by the use of a handful of trigger words.



Never base your guess about the author's tone on a single word.

05. APPLICATION BASED

- Take information and conclusions in the passage and extrapolate them to similar situations or ideas.



Identify the crux of an argument and see how it relates to a similar situation.



Answers that seem logical but are not directly supported by the text should be avoided.

06. PASSAGE STRUCTURE

- Determine the relationship between different parts of a passage.



To find the correct answer, understand the relationship between each idea and paragraph.



Do not get confused between the ideas that support a thesis and the main thesis idea

COMMON QUESTION STEMS

- The attitude of the author of the passage toward x is best described as one of
- The tone of the author is best described as

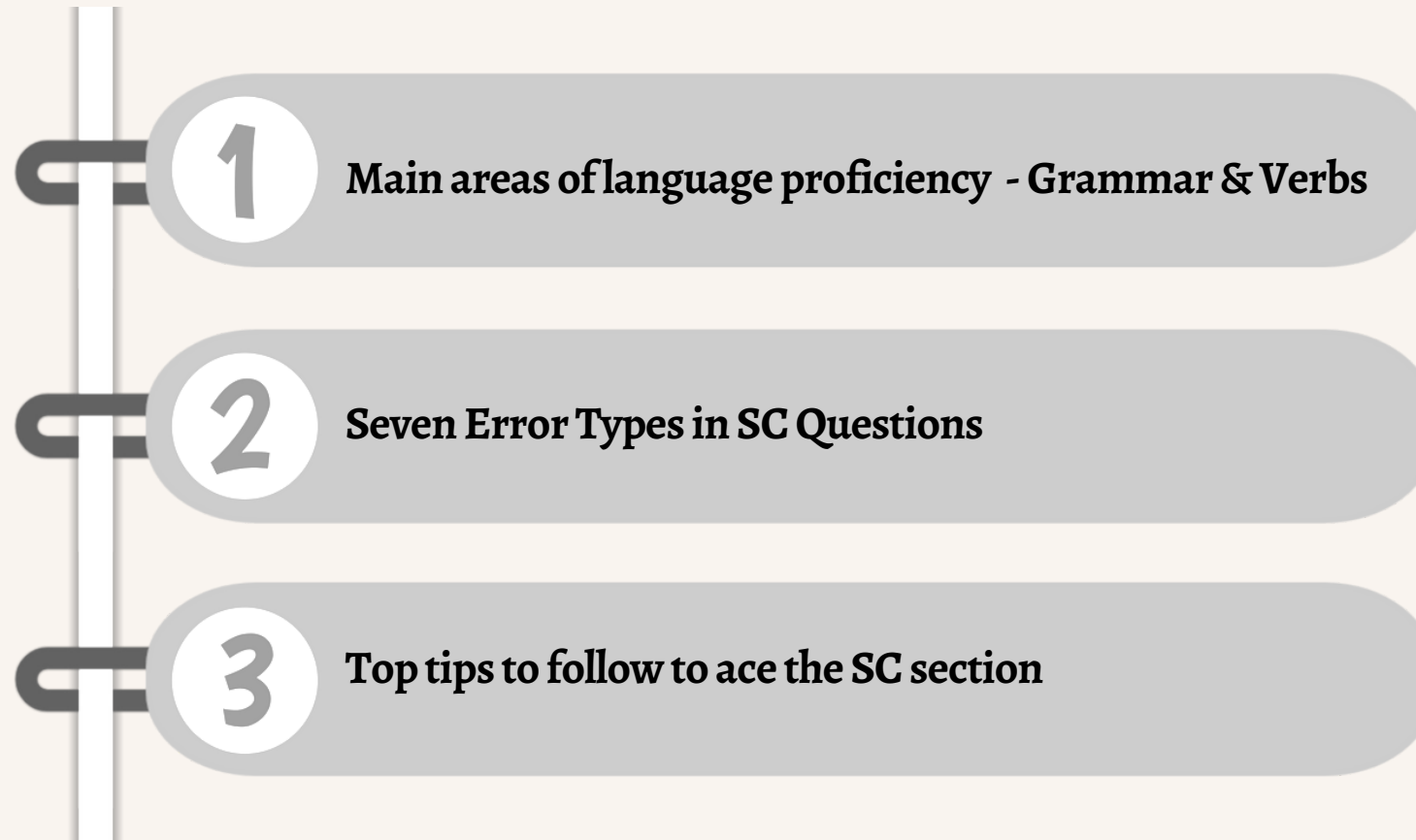
- The author of the passage would be most likely to agree with which of the following?
- Which of the following statements would provide the most logical continuation of the final paragraph?

- One function of the third paragraph of this passage is to
- The author uses the adjective x in line y to emphasize that
- The author refers to x in line y primarily to



CHAPTER 2: SENTENCE CORRECTION

Chapter Flow



MAIN AREAS OF PROFICIENCY - GRAMMAR



NOUNS	PRONOUNS	TIPS AND RULES IN PRONOUNS
- Common Noun (basic identifier) - Proper Noun (Name Specific) - Count Noun (one, two, three) - Non-Count noun (milk, water) - Collective noun (class, herd, choir)	- Personal pronoun (she, it, they) - Demonstrative pronoun (this, that) - Interrogative pronoun (who, whom) - Relative pronoun (milk, water) - Indefinite pronoun (anything, anybody) - Reflexive pronoun (myself, themselves)	✓ The pronouns must have an antecedent Pause everytime when you see it, its, they, them and their and verify that it has an antecedent ✓ The pronoun and antecedent must agree in number It, its - singular antecedent and they, them are plural antecedents ✓ The pronoun must be unambiguous
VERB	SUBJECT AND VERB AGREEMENT	THREE-STEP METHOD
Verbs are required components of all sentences. A sentence is incomplete unless it has a verb and a subject. Verbs often denote the action taken by the subject. As an example: <i>John <u>throws</u> the ball</i>	- Always agree with each other - Four types to confuse you: - Phrase between the subject and verb - Subject follows the verb - Compound Subject - Indefinite pronoun as subject (somebody, someone, anyone)	READ - Don't just simply read the underlined parts as context is essential to find the right answer DISSECT - Search for hints that point to the grammatical rule that is being tested by the question. COMPARE - Look for the answer that has the same meaning without any grammatical errors

MAIN AREAS OF PROFICIENCY - VERBS



Past Continuous
(was playing, were
looking)

Present Continuous
(is explaining, are
looking, am cooking)

Future Continuous
(he will have been)

PAST TENSE

PRESENT

FUTURE

Past Perfect
(had met, had given)

Present perfect
(has finished, have gone,
has made)

Future perfect
(will have)

SEVEN ERROR TYPES

7

SUBJECT-VERB AGREEMENT

Subject and verb should always be in agreement i.e., singular subject should be followed by singular verb. Four types to confuse you: (a) Phrase between the subject and verb, (b) Subject follows the verb, (c) Compound Subject, (d) Indefinite pronoun as subject (somebody, someone, anyone)

1

2

MODIFIERS

Modifiers are words, phrases, or clauses that limit or add to the meaning of other words, phrases, or clauses. Adjectives modify nouns or pronouns. Adverbs modify verbs or adjectives.

ADJECTIVE

the red car

Modifier

Modified noun

ADVERB

he runs quickly

Modified noun

Modifier

PARALLELISM

Parallelism is defined similarly to what it is in mathematics. They're straight and evenly spaced, and they're unmistakably "parallel."

For example:

Singing

Eating

Running

3

4

PRONOUN AGREEMENT

To begin answering a pronoun question, find and identify the pronouns in the phrase. Some common pronouns are : mine, yours, his, hers, its, ours, their's and everyone's

VERB TIME SEQUENCE

When you come across a verb in a GMAT phrase, you must not only examine for subject-verb agreement but also ensure that it is in the right tense, mood, and voice. Most additional forms of the verb are formed using the infinitive: to sing → singing, sang, will sing

5



IDIOMS

Idioms are not unbreakable laws of grammar. Instead, they are deeply ingrained English language verbal preferences and habits. Look for these common tricks on GMAT:

- There is no “as” after “consider,” while both “regard” and “think of” need the “as.”
- Avoid the construction *to be/being* because they are usually passive.



COMPARISONS

IA comparison might be erroneous in two ways:

- a) **Not logical** : For this scenario, ask yourself if the comparison is for the same categories
- b) **Not grammatical**: For this scenario, check if a valid idiom is being used and whether the same grammatical form (parallel) is being used

TOP TIPS FOR THE SC SECTION



You are looking for the **BEST ANSWER** and not the **PERFECT ANSWER**

Whether you agree with the arrangement or not, choose the response that is superior to all other answer choices.



Meaning matters in **Sentence Correction**

Incorrect responses in Sentence Correction can occasionally be absolutely grammatical while yet conveying absurd or absurd ideas.



Use the **best split** rather than the **initial split**

Don't focus too much on the first distinction you see. If you don't know the rule right now, you won't be able to recall it in the next 80 seconds. Instead, look for a different rule that you are familiar with.



While applying parallelism, work from the **very end of the question**

Start at the end of the list rather than the beginning of it for the finest parallelism trick. Look for the parallel marking.



Focus on the **differences**

Instead of reading them one at a time, focus on the distinctions between them. One of the two possible solutions must be incorrect, thus at least one of the discrepancies must provide you with useful information.

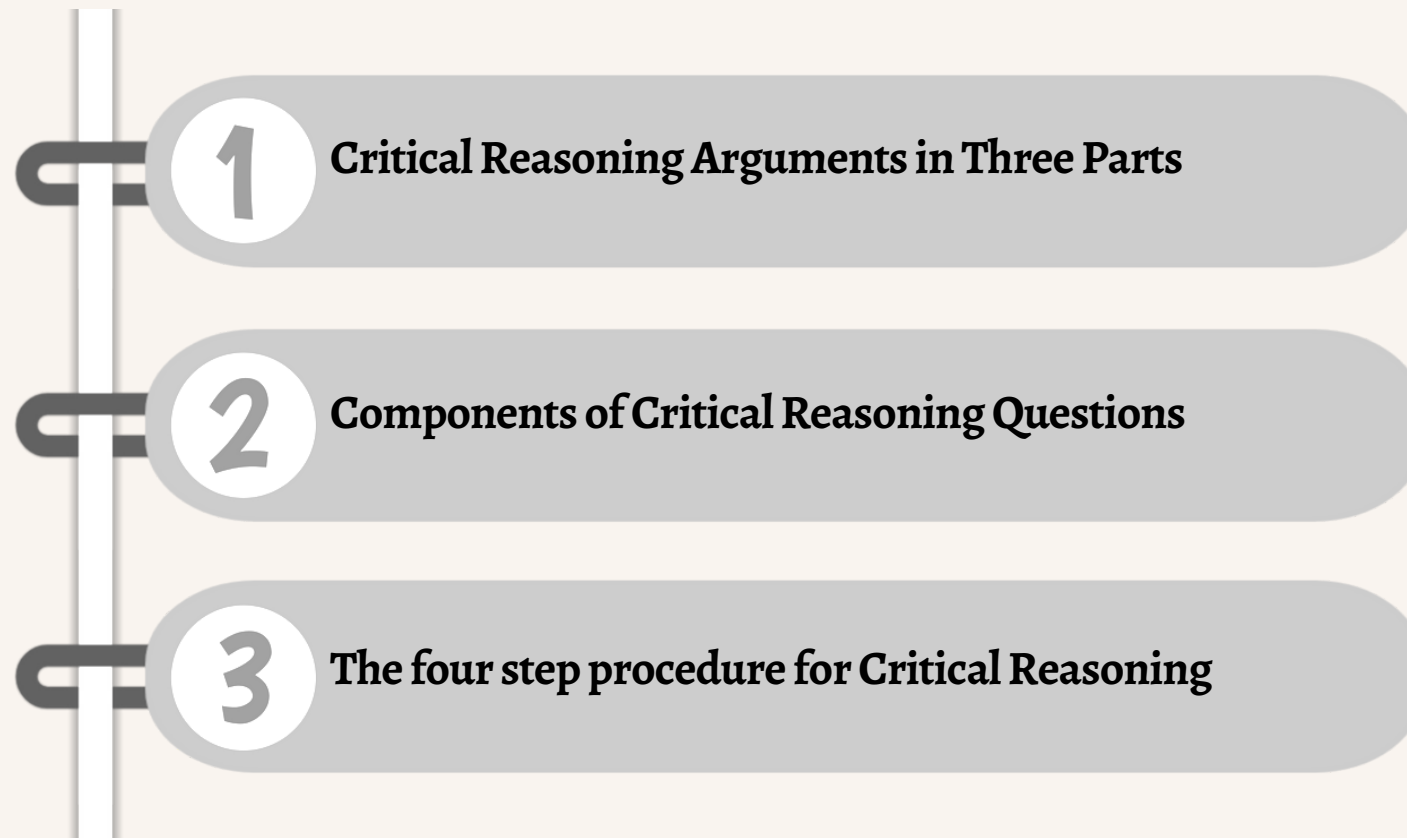


Try **summarizing and simplifying the sentence**

Think “workers” rather than “employees of a Fortune 500 firm.” Think “the best strategy” rather than “the most beneficial approach to tackling any challenge.”

CHAPTER 3: CRITICAL REASONING

Chapter Flow

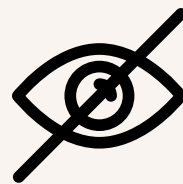


CRITICAL REASONING ARGUMENTS IN 3-PARTS

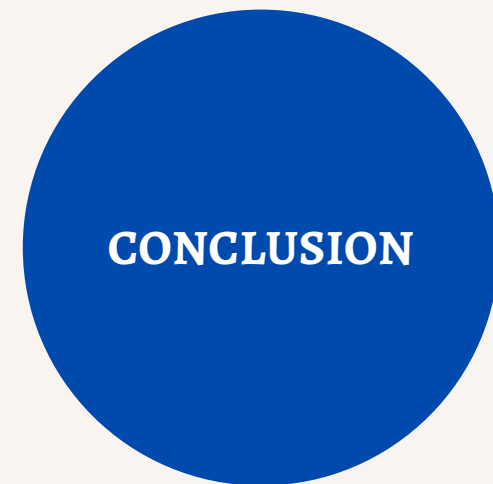


These are evidences.
Indicator words are:

- Since
- Because
- As indicated
- Given
- Can be seen from



Finding any
assumptions or
discrepancies between
the data and the
conclusion is a critical
GMAT ability. There will
be no indicators for it



You can be asked to
pinpoint the conclusion
Indicator words are:

- Thus
- Hence
- Therefore
- For the reason

COMPONENTS OF CRITICAL REASONING QUESTIONS



THE PASSAGE

An argument or even a list of facts can be found in the first part of the inquiry. The GMAT's passage, often referred to as the stimulus, is **true in its premises. Don't debate them.** Therefore, for the sake of the inquiry, you should suppose that the price did really grow sevenfold in this scenario.



THE STIMULUS

The Stem, also known as "the stimulus," might be expressed as a question or as a statement. **Watch out for terms like "EXCEPT" in sentences.** The Stem is crucial since it will provide you with **information about the question category** (giving you a huge insight into the question). The majority of the critical reasoning course will be spent going over these 20+ sorts of questions.



THE ANSWER CHOICES

Five options are always available. It is your responsibility to identify the **one solution that "best" fulfils the criterion.** This is frequently accomplished most effectively by identifying something "wrong" with 4 of the 5 possible answers. Other times, one response will stand out as unmistakably "correct."

THE FOUR-STEP PROCEDURE

STEP 1 **Understand the Stem**



The GMAT commonly uses only about 20 or so question stem types. Be thorough with all. While attempting the GMAT make sure to understand and identify it.

STEP 2 **Read the Question**



Read thoroughly and quickly! Not much can be skimmed. To distinguish between premises and conclusions, you must pay close attention to any significant terms.

STEP 3 **Predict the Answer**



Developing your own response to the question might be beneficial before reading the possible answers. Get a basic concept rather than trying to forecast the precise response so you don't enter the answer selections carelessly.

STEP 4 **Evaluate the Choices**



You may make things simpler on yourself by removing a few options right away since one or two of the response options will be total garbage. Work as methodically as possible. Don't develop the habit of deliberating your decisions for minutes at a time since time is an issue.

HOW TO GO FROM V₃₀ TO V₄₀ IN GMAT?



- ✓ Always time yourself while attempting questions
- ✓ Master every topic in each section - remember practice is key.
- ✓ Once you have mastered each section, your goal should be to be able to solve **Medium Difficulty questions** with at least **80% accuracy** in a timed environment & **Hard questions** with at least **60% accuracy** in a timed environment.
- ✓ While practicing questions, make a note of all the topics where your accuracy is less than 50% and always go back and strengthen your basic concepts and understanding
- ✓ Read as many English newspapers, books, journals as possible. Reading will truly strengthen your basic understanding of the English language and help you answer verbal questions with greater ease!



1 Northbank 43A Regent Court
London, United Kingdom

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